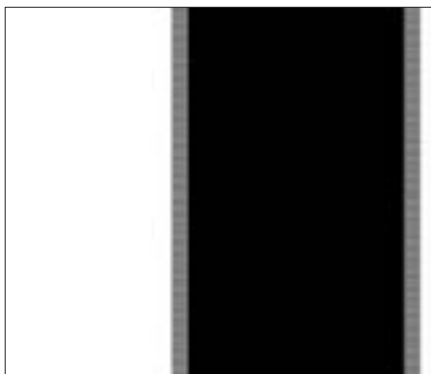


5.2 Google Base

Google Base is one of the lesser-understood tools in Google's services stable. Even experienced users find themselves somewhat confused about what Google Base is. However, understanding and effectively using Google Base is one of those little things that help in



The Google Base home page

increasing your search engine rankings. According to Google, "...based on your items' relevance, users may find them in their results for searches on Froogle, Google Maps and even our main Google Web search."

So what is Google Base? Rather than wait for Google to automatically crawl your Web site and index it, Google Base enables users to manually submit content they want included in Google's indexing services and that will show up in search results for queries. In effect it can act as an ad hoc hosting service for people without Web sites and who want to house their material in a centralised location.

As with other services, you will need a Google account to use the service. Once you are signed in, go to the Base home page (www.google.com/base/).

There are three ways you can post items to Google Base: one item at a time if you have less than 10 items, via Bulk Upload, or by using the Google Base API (Application Programming Interface), which can be used to program automatic publishing to Google Base. Visit the site to learn more about Bulk Upload and